Michael F Bergmann

Performance, projection, and machine collaboration

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Selected Works

2026	"Before I Was This." Generative text work. flashDRIVE: Digital Arts Fundraiser Exhibition, InterAccess, Toronto, April 22 – May 9, 2026. Curated by Miriam Arbus.
2026	Nuptials (feature film). Producer, projection design, and live in-camera VFX. Directed by Sean Braune, Para-sight Productions. Official release February 13, 2026 (Freestyle Digital Media). Best World Feature Film, Austin Revolution Film Festival, 2022.
2025	The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025.
2025	"To my creators…" Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík.
2024	Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work "To my creators…"
2024	Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024.
2024	Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.
2019	"The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1." Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019.
2017	Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Harbourfront NextSteps, Fleck Dance Theatre, Toronto.
2016	YET. Projection design; choreography by Heidi Strauss. Ryerson Dances, Ryerson Theatre, Toronto.
2014	He Left Quietly. Projection design; directed by Leora Morris. SummerWorks Performance Festival, Toronto. Best Production, 2014.
2014	echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert. Video design and system design team; choreography by Grisha Coleman. ACCAD, The Ohio State University.
2014	TECHknowSELF. Wrote, directed, and designed this multimedia performance (MFA thesis). Becton Engineering Center, Yale University.

2013 – 2014	Accidental Death of an Anarchist. Projection design; directed by Christopher Bayes. Yale Repertory Theatre / Berkeley Repertory Theatre.
2013	Water Closeted (projection installation). Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery.
2012	On Guard (projection installation). Group showing, Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery.

Recent Creative Work

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2025	The Frankenstein Project. Producer, with Debashis Sinha. Performance Studio Theatre, TMU, November 18–22, 2025.
2025	291 by Jade O'Keeffe. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Lisa Dixon. Peterborough Theatre Guild, November 1–15, 2025.
2025	"To my creators…" Solo work exhibited at the Creative AI Symposium, TMU, April 2, 2025; created during the SÍM residency, Reykjavík.
2024	AVARA 2024 installation. Led eight students in a semester-long research-creation installation presented at AVARA 2024, OAMK, Oulu, Finland.
2024	Shipwreck. Group exhibition with UKAI Projects and five Canadian artists, SÍM Gallery, Reykjavík, Iceland, following a month-long residency; includes solo work "To my creators…"
2024	Labour and Us. Workshop series (March 14 – April 17, 2024) and performance, co-created and performed with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson; roundtable with Alan Filewod, Tom Scholte, Cynthia Ashperger, and Judith Thompson. ImprovLab, University of Guelph, April 19, 2024.
2024	Almost Alchemy. Two 360° video experiences of improvised research-creation performance. RUBIX, TMU, January 25, 2024.
2023	"rocketmanperson." Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, October 1, 2023.
2023	"Who's There?" Improvised performance with Lucas Carravetta, Matt Endahl, and Aimée Dawn Robinson. Silence, Guelph, April 1, 2023.
2023	Living Newspaper 2.0. Projection design; directed by Julie Labagnara. George Luscombe Theatre, Toronto.

2019	"The Uncanny Robots Project: Phase 1." Research-creation premiere examining human-robot interaction through dance, commissioned for the opening of the Creative Technology Lab @ FCAD, TMU, October 2019.

Residencies

2025 – 2026	Mentor, Setsubun Digital Media Residency, Japanese Canadian Cultural Centre, Toronto
2024	Artist-in-residence, SÍM Residency (with UKAI Projects), Reykjavík, Iceland — Shipwreck, June 2–30, 2024
2022	Artist-in-residence, Ingenuity Labs Research Institute, Queen's University, Kingston
2021 – 2022	Ferment AI Residency artist; residency output presented in Berlin, October 2022
2014	Artist-in-residence, Ross Creek Centre for the Arts, NS — Incorporeus
2014	Workshop residency, ACCAD, The Ohio State University — echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert

Awards

2022	Best World Feature Film: Nuptials, Austin Revolution Film Festival (as producer)
2014	Best Production: He Left Quietly, SummerWorks Performance Festival (as designer)
2012 – 2014	Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University ($40,000 USD; held throughout the MFA)
2009	Spirit of the Fringe, Prague Fringe Festival
2006	Short-listed, Prix Molière, Theatre Glendon

Grants and Fellowships

2024	Erasmus+ staff mobility funding, OAMK, Oulu, Finland
2024	The Creative School Travel Grant, TMU — Shipwreck Iceland project. $1,000.
2022	TMU Work Study RA Program — "Mechanical Waves: Machine Learning gesture reactive human-robot installation." $3,800.
2021	SSHRC Partnership Engage Grant, COVID-19 Special Initiative — "Visual Music: Enhancing the National Arts Centre Orchestra's remote connection with their audience during COVID-19 social restrictions through innovative digital tools." PI: Cintia Cristiá; Co-Is: Michael Bergmann, David Bouchard. $24,620.

2019	Cirque du Soleil Entertainment Group / Future of Live Entertainment Lab — "l'automate: Expanding the possibility of performance through robotics." Co-I with Jonathon Anderson. $7,500.
2019	FCAD Special Seed Grant — The Uncanny Robots Project. $4,000.
2018	Undergraduate Research Opportunity, OVPRI, Ryerson — "Augmented-Reality based Pre-Visualization system for theatrical spaces." $9,888.
2018	Learning and Teaching Enhancement Fund, Ryerson — "The Creative Laboratory Project." Co-I with Pavlo Bosyy. $13,000.
2012 – 2014	Eldon Elder Fellowship, Yale University. $40,000 USD.

Projection and Installation Design

2019	Crossing Borders. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Gill Foster. International Arts Youth Festival, Kingston upon Thames, UK.
2019	Foreign Tongue. Projection design; directed by Cynthia Ashperger. NextStage Festival, Toronto.
2018	Nuptials (feature film). Projection design and live in-camera VFX; directed by Sean Braune. Para-sight Productions. (Released 2026; see Creative Research Output.)
2018	Crossing Borders. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Peggy Shannon and Gill Foster. Parodos Festival, Toronto.
2018	291. Projection co-design with Kristen Ferguson; directed by Rebecca Ballarin. Parodos Festival, Toronto.
2017	Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Harbourfront NextSteps, Fleck Dance Theatre, Toronto.
2016	YET. Projection design; choreography by Heidi Strauss. Ryerson Dances, Ryerson Theatre, Toronto.
2016	Slaughterhouse/Requiem. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Belinda McGuire Dance Projects.
2014	Incorporeus. Projection design; choreography by Belinda McGuire. Belinda McGuire Dance Projects.
2014	He Left Quietly. Projection design; directed by Leora Morris. SummerWorks Performance Festival, Toronto. Best Production, 2014.
2014	echo::system Action Station #2: The Desert. Video design and system design team; choreography by Grisha Coleman. ACCAD, The Ohio State University.
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2013	Water Closeted (projection installation). Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery.
2013	AlgoRhythym. Visual component for Matt Otto's sound performance thesis. Yale School of Drama.
2012	Iphigenia Among the Stars. Projection design; directed by Jack Tamburri. Yale School of Drama.
2012	Fox Play. Projection design; directed by Lileana Blain-Cruz. Yale School of Drama.
2012	Dracula. Projection design; directed by Jack Tamburri. Yale Cabaret.
2012	On Guard (projection installation). Group showing, Gallery + Drama, Yale University Art Gallery.
2011	Creation 2011. Projection design; directed by Sarah Krasnow. Yale Cabaret.
2010	Leer. Projection design. BergARTS, Toronto.
2006	Terre Rouge. Projection design; directed by Guillaume Bernardi. Theatre Glendon, Toronto.
2006	The Marriage of Bette and Boo. Projection design; directed by Mel Couture. Theatre Glendon, Toronto.

Direction, Lighting, and Film

2010	Leer. Direction. BergARTS, Toronto.
2010	Three Sisters. Assistant direction; directed by Cynthia Ashperger. Ryerson Theatre (Abrams), Toronto.
2010	The Centre of Everything Civilized. Lighting design; directed by John Jack Patterson. Toronto Fringe Festival.
2010	WET. Lighting design; directed by John Jack Patterson. Toronto Fringe Festival.
2009	This Still Night. Co-direction with Meghan Gennings. Prague Fringe Festival. Spirit of the Fringe award, 2009.
2009	Mother Courage. Assistant direction; directed by Richard Greenblatt. Ryerson Theatre, Toronto.
2009	A Summer's Day. Lighting design; directed by Cynthia Ashperger. Alley Theatre, Toronto.
2009	A Glendale Christmas. Lighting design; directed by Tom Haxell. Hamilton Fringe Festival.
2009	Blood Buds. Lighting design; directed by Barbara Johnston. Ryerson Theatre (Abrams), Toronto.
2009	Le Nez. Lighting design; directed by Rebecca Vandevelde. Theatre Glendon, Toronto.
2009	An Encounter (short). Cinematography and editing. Roving Eye Productions.

2009	Transmigration (short). Cinematography and editing. Bergmann & Braune.
2008	LOFT Christmas Concert. Lighting design. St. James Cathedral, Toronto.
2008	Romeo & Juliet. Lighting design; directed by Ian Watson. Ryerson Theatre (Abrams), Toronto.
2007	Koi-san. Direction. Theatre Glendon, Toronto.
2006	Chimera: A Telling of Jekyll and Hyde. Direction. Theatre Glendon, Toronto.
2005	Most Guys Today (feature). Cinematography and editing. Greek Chorus Productions.
2004	Who Goes to Movies? (short). Cinematography and editing. Hammergate Productions.
2003	Blind Hindsight (short). Cinematography and editing. Bergmann & Braune.

Collectives and Affiliations

2025 – present	Canadian Artificial Intelligence Association
2023 – present	Almost Alchemy — improvised, multi-disciplinary performance collective (founding member)
2022 – 2023	Synectic Assembly — AI-driven art collective (founding member)
2021 – 2022	Diagonal — speaker series and reading group, BMO Lab, University of Toronto
2019 – present	United States Institute for Theatre Technology (USITT)
2018 – present	Associated Designers of Canada / IATSE Local ADC 659
2018 – present	Canadian Institute for Theatre Technology (CITT)

Selected Press

2023	"Get the inside scoop on game-changing innovations in augmented reality with the new VisionPro." The Creative School Top 5, July 4, 2023.
2023	Faculty Spotlight: Michael F Bergmann. Performance at The Creative School, June 27, 2023.
2022	"Students Are Excited And Hopeful For What The Metaverse May Bring." The Eyeopener, October 5, 2022.
2022	"Michael F. Bergmann On The Merging of Live Arts and Technology." Toronto Life, April 29, 2022.
2021	"Emerging technology that's here to stay." CityNews Toronto, June 18, 2021.

2020	“Can you feel empathy for a dancing robot?” Ryerson Innovation Magazine, Issue 33, 2020.
2020	“FCAD students embrace opportunity to redefine performance.” Nicole Bartnicki, Ryerson University, May 2020.
2019	“Premiere of robot dance performance launches Creative Technology Lab.” Ryerson University, November 2019.
2015	Q&A Personal interview, Meghan Perkins, Live Design Magazine, 2015.

Education

2022 – present	PhD Candidate, Critical Studies in Improvisation, University of Guelph. Expected 2027.
2011 – 2014	MFA, Design (Projection Design Specialization), Yale School of Drama, Yale University
2006 – 2011	BFA, Theatre Performance Production, Ryerson Theatre School, Toronto Metropolitan University (coursework completed December 2010; graduated May 2011)